

Leczo

Check out my best recipe for the most classic leczo. This leczo is a fantastic and very seasonal idea for dinner. You can serve leczo with rice, bread, or enjoy it on its own. It's healthy and delicious.

- a simple recipe for leczo
- detailed instructions and step-by-step photos
- the most delicious leczo made with bell peppers and sausage

Prep time: 30 minutes

Cooking time: 45 minutes

Servings: 1,750 grams of leczo

Per 100 grams of leczo: Calories 81 kcal Carbohydrates 6 g - Of which sugars 4 g Protein 3 g Fat 5 g Diet: gluten-free, low-sugar

Ingredients

- bell peppers: 2 yellow, 2 red, 1 green = 850 g
- 6 medium raspberry tomatoes - 850 g
- 3 medium onions - 350 g
- 4 medium garlic cloves
- 1 link of sausage - 200 g
- 4 tablespoons of oil or lard
- a handful of fresh oregano
- spices: 1 level tablespoon of sweet paprika, 1 level teaspoon of smoked paprika, ½ level teaspoon of hot paprika, 1 level teaspoon of salt, ¼ level teaspoon of pepper

Leczo

A glass holds 250 ml in my household.

The vegetables were weighed before peeling or preparing them.

The calories were calculated based on the ingredients I used. This is therefore an approximate calorie count, as your ingredients may have a different calorie content than the ones I used. With the specified amount of ingredients, you'll get over 1,700 grams of delicious leczo.

Leczo is a dish that originated in Hungarian cuisine. However, it's safe to say that it has also become a popular dish here in Poland. Different countries have different customs, and here in Poland, too, there are many versions and variations of leczo. This time, I've tried to share a leczo recipe that, in my opinion, is the most typical and basic one, tailored to our Polish taste preferences.

Recipe for Leczo

I prepare leczo from start to finish in a single, large pot. I don't sauté the vegetables or meat separately in a skillet. You can easily do this in the pot you'll be using, as long as you add the ingredients in the correct order. Before you start making leczo, I recommend reading the entire recipe first so you can prepare in advance for the next steps.

First, I peel and chop the onions into larger pieces. You can use regular onions or sweet onions. Leczo made with sweet onions will be sweeter and milder, and the onion flavor will be less pronounced.

Set the burner to medium heat and start heating the pot. Pour four tablespoons of vegetable cooking oil into the pot (you can use common refined canola oil, grapeseed oil, or rice bran oil) or use lard. I also recommend mild olive oil. Set the burner to medium heat. Once the fat is hot, add the chopped onion. Sauté it for five minutes. Stir the onion occasionally with a wooden spoon.

While the onions are sautéing, prepare the garlic and sausage. Peel four medium-sized garlic cloves and slice them. Cut a good-quality sausage (such as Brocka or Podwawelska) into thick slices, then cut each slice in half. Add the garlic and sausage to the pot with the onions. Sauté everything together for ten minutes.

Tip: If you're not a big fan of garlic, you can leave it out of the recipe. If you used lard instead of oil, you can also leave out the sausage. In my recipe, there's not much sausage compared to the amount of vegetables. My main goal was to bring out the umami flavor in the leczo.

Sauté the onion, garlic, and sausage for ten minutes (without a lid the whole time). You can prepare the peppers while they're cooking. Wash the bell peppers under cold, running water and remove the seeds. Cut them into smaller pieces, then into strips that aren't too long and no wider than 1 cm.

Tip 1: I don't add even a pinch of sugar to my leczó. It turns out quite sweet because it contains a lot of bell peppers. If you use only yellow and green bell peppers, it will be less sweet. The more red bell peppers you use, the sweeter the leczó will be.

Tip 2: At this point, you can also enrich your leczó by adding zucchini, mushrooms, or eggplant.

Place the prepared peppers in the pot with the leczó. Also add paprika: one level tablespoon of sweet paprika, one level teaspoon of smoked paprika, and half a level teaspoon of hot paprika. You can now add one peeled and chopped tomato to the pot, along with all its juice and a little water, or half a glass of tomato puree. This is because you need to add a little liquid to the leczó so the peppers don't burn while simmering.

At this stage, cover the pot with a lid and simmer the vegetables over a heat setting lower than medium for 20–25 minutes. Every five minutes, stir the leczó with a wooden spoon. While you're at it, check to see if you need to add a little water or tomato juice to the leczó.

Tip 3: If you're not a fan of smoked paprika, you can leave it out.

Traditionally, while the leczó is simmering, you can prepare its final ingredient: tomatoes. I choose raspberry tomatoes. You can peel the tomatoes thinly or add them with the skin on. I peel them using a special vegetable peeler. You can also make a small cut in the tomatoes near the stem end. Then blanch them in boiling water and peel off the thin skin with your fingers.

Cut the tomatoes into larger pieces and place them in a bowl with a handful of fresh oregano. Add a level teaspoon of salt and 1/4 level teaspoon of freshly ground pepper.

Tip 4: You can also use dried oregano or substitute thyme for oregano.

After 20–25 minutes of simmering, the peppers should be tender. Add the tomatoes to the pot with the lecho. Stir everything together and cook for the last five minutes, uncovered.

The lecho is now ready. I recommend tasting it one last time before serving. You might want to add a little more salt or pepper. Or perhaps you prefer your lecho with more sauce. In that case, add more tomatoes, tomato juice, passata, or canned tomatoes to the pot. To make the lecho more tangy, you can add lemon juice or tomato paste.

You can eat this lecho on its own, without any sides. It also tastes great with a slice of bread, rice, or your favorite grain.